physical mechanism to realize his proposal, it was hard to investigate Mach’s ideas with any precision.

From our modern vantage point, a reasonable guess is that gravity might have something to do with the influences involved in Mach’s suggestion. In the following decades, this possibility caught Einstein’s attention and he drew much inspiration from Mach’s proposal while developing his own theory of gravity, the general theory of relativity. When the dust of relativity had finally settled, the question of whether space is a something—of whether the absolutist or relationist view of space is correct—was transformed in a manner that shattered all previous ways of looking at the universe.